

H/O – Braden Scale Pressure Ulcer Risk Assessment

Day 9 | GA Healthcare Training & Consulting | Nurse Aide Training Program

Name: _____ Date: _____

What Is the Braden Scale?

The Braden Scale is a standardized tool used to identify residents at risk for developing pressure ulcers (pressure injuries). It evaluates 6 categories. Scores range from 6 to 23. Lower scores = higher risk.

Risk Category	Total Score	Risk Level	Action
Very High Risk	9 or less	Severe	Reposition every 1 hour; specialty mattress
High Risk	10 – 12	High	Reposition every 2 hours; pressure-relieving surface
Moderate Risk	13 – 14	Moderate	Reposition every 2–4 hours; monitor skin closely
Mild Risk	15 – 18	Mild	Reposition as tolerated; skin assessment each shift
No Risk	19 – 23	Minimal	Routine care; preventive positioning

Pressure Ulcer Stages

Stage	Description
Stage I	Non-blanchable redness on intact skin; area may be painful, firm, or warm.
Stage II	Partial thickness skin loss; appears as a shallow open ulcer or blister.
Stage III	Full thickness skin loss; subcutaneous fat may be visible; no bone, tendon, or muscle exposed.
Stage IV	Full thickness skin/tissue loss; bone, tendon, or muscle is exposed.
Unstageable	Full thickness loss; base covered by slough or eschar — cannot determine depth.
Deep Tissue Injury	Purple or maroon area of intact skin due to pressure/shear; may evolve rapidly.

CNA Prevention Responsibilities

- Reposition residents on a schedule per the care plan.
- Inspect skin during every bathing, transfer, and dressing activity.
- Report any redness, breakdown, or skin changes to the nurse immediately.
- Keep skin clean and dry; apply moisture barrier as directed.
- Ensure adequate nutrition and hydration to support skin integrity.
- Use protective devices (heel protectors, foam wedges) as ordered.